



PREDICTED TEAM

Prabhsimran Singh

Priyansh Arya

Shashank Singh

Glenn Maxwell

Nehal Wadhera

Marcus Stoinis

Azmatullah Omarzai

Marco Jansen

Harpreet Brar

Yuzvendra Chahal

IMPACT PLAYER

Arshdeep/Priyansh

COACH

Ricky Ponting

HOME VENUE

Maharaja Yadavindra Singh International Cricket Stadium, New Chandigarh & HPCA Stadium, Dharamsala

LAST SEASON

Ninth

Power-packed opening batter

176.63

Priyansh Arya scored 325 runs for Delhi in the 2024 Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy at a strike rate of 176. In the Delhi Premier League last year, he amassed 608 runs at a staggering strike rate of 199. Arya's presence is likely the reason Punjab Kings opted against signing a high-profile opening batter. The team's PowerPlay run rate in the last two seasons was below nine runs per over – ranking among the bottom five of the 10 teams. His inclusion could help address the team's scoring struggles at the start of an innings.

Support for slow bowlers

6.71

Spinners conceded just 6.71 runs per over at the Maharaja Yadavindra Singh International Cricket Stadium in New Chandigarh. Since 2023, only Lucknow's home venue (6.41) has provided better support for slow bowlers. Spinners also picked up 150 wickets at an average of 20 at Punjab Kings' new home ground. In contrast, pacers conceded over eight runs per over, with 197 wickets at an average of 22. Captain Shreyas Iyer is likely to maximise the three spinners at his disposal – Yuzvendra Chahal, Harpreet Brar, and Glenn Maxwell – ensuring they bowl their full quota of 12 overs combined. However, Punjab Kings will play just four matches in New Chandigarh this season before shifting to Dharamsala for its final three home games. While spinners have been more economical than pacers at the HPCA Stadium too, the advantage is not as pronounced as it is in New Chandigarh.